

Photograph by BANDEEP SINGH

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- In the past few years, global supply chains have been very vulnerable to disruptions, destabilising the flow of goods
- Countries are moving from globalised to regionalised supply chains to better secure their trade and mitigate risk
- Energy dependence is still a strategic vulnerability for countries, making them susceptible to global disruptions
- Infrastructure is central to India's economic growth. And its foundation is a robust transport system of ports, roads, rail networks
- The Adani Group is undergoing a massive organisational transformation. For the next five years, the planned capital expenditure is Rs 2 lakh crore annually

perspective has become critical as the current crisis has shown the risks of import dependence, he said.

On the strategic importance of diversifying trade routes and new infra projects, he pointed to the Nicobar project. Indeed, if the Straits of Malacca—one of the possible four 'choke points' in global trade—is affected, Nicobar could play a great role from India's perspective in terms of supply chain reliance, says Adani. He added that India's infra investments must look to "de-risk" supply chains from geopolitical hazards.

The Adani Group itself is undergoing a massive organisational transformation. For the next five years, the planned capital expenditure is Rs 2 lakh crore annually. The group is scaling up in every sector—renewable energy from 18 GW to 50 GW, port capacity from 600 million to 1.2 billion tonnes, thermal capacity from 17 GW to 45 GW, and airport passenger capacity from 100 million to 200 million. And all this by 2030-31.

In a rare admission, Adani also admitted that the group had faltered in "not communicating our story enough", which allowed external narratives to dominate public perception. As for future aspirations, Adani said it is to become the world's cheapest power producer and logistics provider, and, of course, be respected as one of the best infrastructure groups globally. ■